

2.6 Decision Tree: When to Escalate Beyond Prompt Corrections

Follow this tree whenever your Ninety-Second Read flags two or more unchecked dimensions. The tree tells you within two minutes whether the fix is a quick prompt adjustment or a structural upgrade requiring the Dialogue Matrix work in Chapters 3 and 4.

Step 1 – Confirm the attempt count.

Have you applied at least three stacked modifiers AND regenerated at least twice?

- **No** → Return to your prompt. Adjust one modifier. Regenerate. Re-run the Ninety-Second Read.
- **Yes** → Proceed to Step 2.

Step 2 – Isolate the drifting dimension(s).

Which specific dimension(s) still feel wrong after two full regeneration cycles?

- ☐ Cadence
- ☐ Vocabulary Range
- ☐ Sentence-Length Variance
- ☐ Emotional Register
- ☐ Conversational Rhythm

Step 3 – Check for a missing psychological anchor.

Does this character have a documented Dialogue Matrix entry yet?

- **No** → The voice drifts because the AI has no deep psychological architecture to anchor the constraints. Flag this scene. Schedule it for Dialogue Matrix work (Chapters 3–4). Move to the next scene. Keep your word count moving.
- **Yes** → Proceed to Step 4.

Step 4 – Check for arc-stage mismatch.

Is the character in a different emotional arc stage than the one encoded in their Matrix?

- **Yes** → Update the relevant Matrix fields to reflect the current arc stage. Regenerate.
- **No** → Proceed to Step 5.

Step 5 – Isolate the platform variable.

Run the same stacked prompt in a second AI tool or model version. Does the voice hold?

- **Yes** → The issue is platform-specific. Adjust modifier values to compensate for that platform's defaults.
- **No** → The constraint language needs refinement. Return to your modifier definitions and sharpen the specificity of the drifting dimension's instruction.